

Injera

A Hex-Board Eating Game Rules & Reference

Overview

Injera is a 2–6 player turn-based strategy game played on a hexagonal board covered with Ethiopian dish tiles. Players compete to eat the most valuable dishes from tiles on the shared board, managing a hand of cards to eat, season, and spice tiles. Bonuses reward specialised eating strategies.

Components

The Board

A fixed hex grid of tiles arranged in a large flat-top hexagon.

Injera tiles

Hexagonal tiles.

- 33 Standard injera tiles.
- 21 Hot injera tiles.
- 7 extra-hot injera tiles.

Dish Tiles

Round dish tiles.

- 7 shiro tiles.
- 7 gomen tiles.
- 7 azifa tiles.
- 7 hot kik alicha tiles.
- 7 hot tikel gomen tiles.
- 7 hot misir wot tiles.
- 7 extra-hot key sir tiles.

Tokens

- 18 standard tahini tokens.
- 12 big tahini tokens.
- 18 coffee tokens.
- 18 beer tokens.
- 12 water tokens.
- 18 awaze tokens.

The Deck

A shared deck of 60 cards.

- 30 clean injera cards.
- 9 rotate injera cards.
- 6 add tahini cards.
- 5 add awaze cards.
- 3 order coffee cards.
- 3 order beer cards.
- 3 order water cards.

Other

- 19 special bonus cards.
- 6 glass tiles.

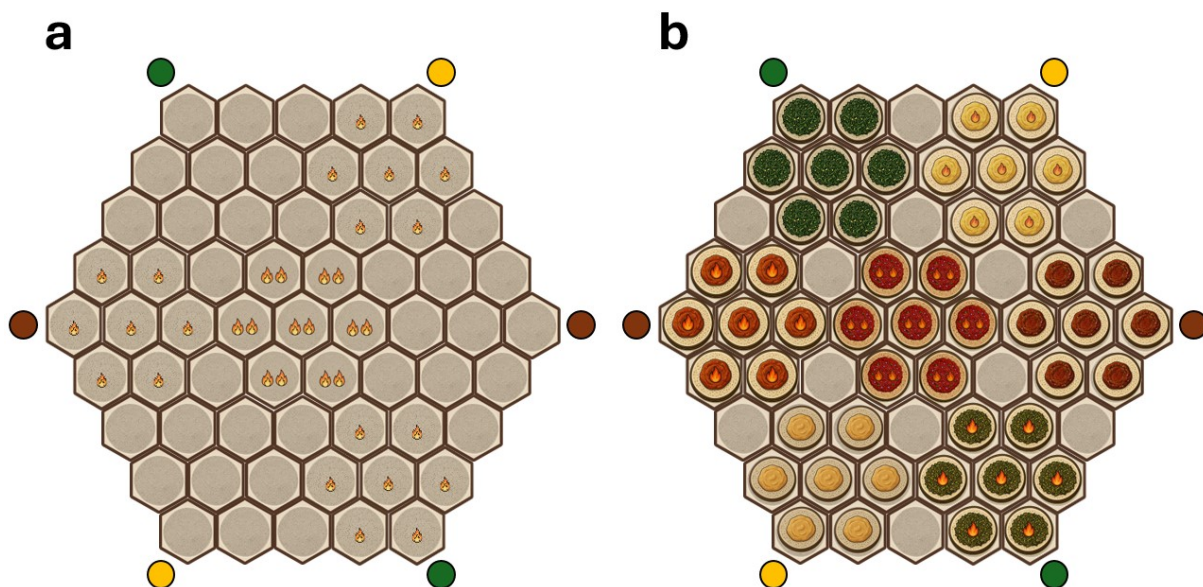


Figure 1: Tiles setup

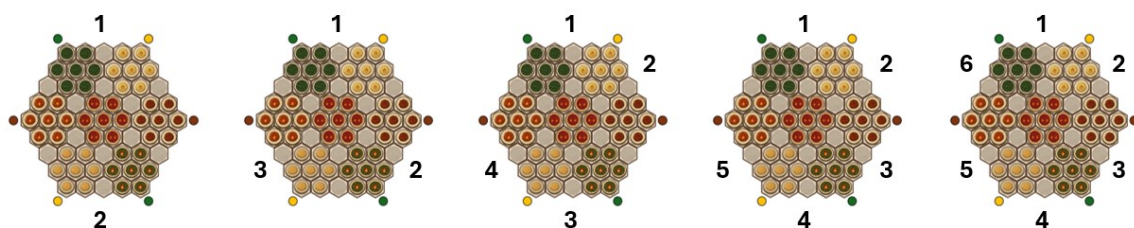


Figure 2: Players positions, for 2, 3, 4, 5, or 6 players, from left to right, respectively.

Setup

1. Place the hexagonal injera tiles on the board as demonstrated in Fig. 1a.
2. Place the circular dish tiles on top of the injera tiles as demonstrated in Fig. 1b.
3. Sit each player in front of a vertices according to the arrangement of Fig. 2.
4. Place a glass tile in front of each player.
5. Shuffle the deck and place it face-down as the draw pile. Designate a place for an empty discard pile beside it.
6. Draws a full starting hand for each player, except for the first player, who gets one card less. The hand size is 4 cards for 2–4 players and 3 cards for 5–6 players.
7. (Optional) Deal *Special Cards*: each player is dealt 3 special cards face-down and keeps 2. Special cards are kept secret until game end.
8. Determine the first player. Play proceeds clockwise.

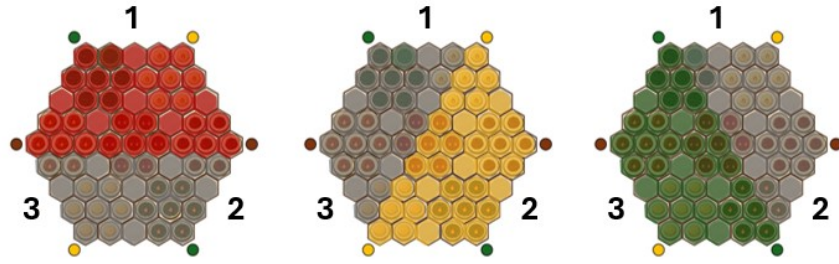


Figure 3: Reachable areas for each player in a 3-players game.

Reachable area

Each player has a reachable area that includes 5 full rows at the start of the game. The limits of the reachable area are signaled by circles of the same color on two sides of the board. The reachable area includes all tiles on the row between the colored circles and all tiles closer to the player than said row. For instance, in the setup of 3 players demonstrated in Fig. 3, the reachable areas of players 1, 2, and 3 are highlighted in red, yellow, and green, respectively.

Turn Structure

On your turn you may perform any number of actions in any order. When you are done, announce the end of your turn. Draw cards from the draw pile until your hand is refilled to your hand size (except of special cases of finishing drinks – see below), then pass to the next player. If there are not enough cards left in the deck, shuffle the discard pile and use it as the new deck. The available actions are:

- Eat a dish.
- Eat an empty tile.
- Order a drink.
- Consume a Drink token.
- Add tahini.
- Add awaze.
- Rotate board.
- Discard & redraw.

Eating a Dish Tile

A player can eat any dish in his or hers reachable area, subject to having enough resources. Eating a dish consists of 3 steps:

1. **Paying:** discard one card from your hand face-down onto the discard pile. Any card type can be used for paying.
2. **Removing the dish:** removing a dish requires clean injera. It can be either a clean injera card from the player's hand or, more commonly, an adjacent, removable injera tile with no dish on it. An injera tile is considered removable if it has at least 2 free vertices, touching no other injera tiles. An injera tile must be reachable to use. The player places the dish tile and any tahini tokens on top of the used tiles in front of him/her. The injera card, if used, is placed in the discard pile. The injera tile, if used, is removed from the game.
3. **Handling hotness:** both dishes and injera tiles can be hot, signaled with a flame. Each flame must be handled for eating the dish. Hotness can be handled with either

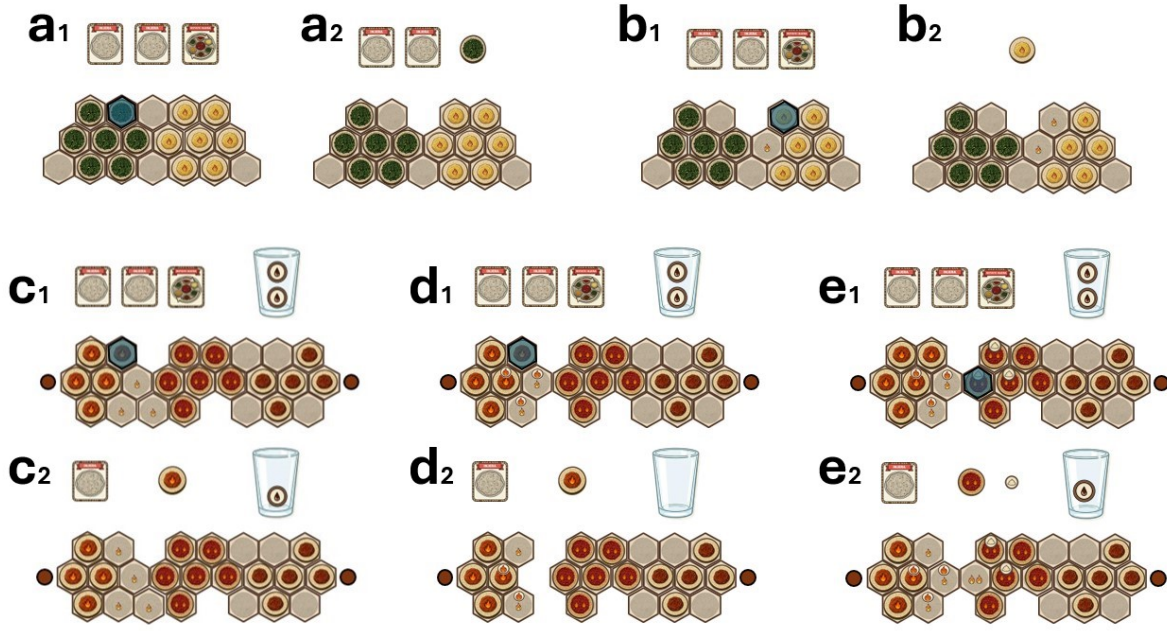


Figure 4: Eating mechanism.

an injera card, a tahini token, or a drink token. Each of these disables the hotness of a single flame.

Fig. 4 demonstrates several eating scenarios for reference. In panel **a**₁, the player has two injera cards and a Rotate Injera card, and intends to eat the gomen tile highlighted in blue. The player pays by discarding the Rotate Injera card and removes the dish using the adjacent empty injera tile, collecting the gomen dish tile (panel **a**₂).

In panel **b**₁, the player intends to eat the highlighted kik alicha tile, and pays by discarding the Rotate Injera card. There are no removable, adjacent empty injera tiles (notice that the adjacent one has only a single free vertices and is not removable) and removes the dish using an injera card, collecting the dish tile (panel **b**₂). The hotness level is 1, as there is one flame symbol on the dish, and is handled using an empty injera card. Panel **c** shows a similar scenario, where the player eats a hot dish, paying with a Rotate card and removing the dish using an injera card. This time, hotness is handled with a coffee token.

In panel **d**₁, there is a removable tile for eating the dish. Notice that the tile is removable even though the 2 free vertices are not adjacent, and that the bottom free one borders the player's unreachable area bottom to the red circles. The empty tile has 2 flames (including one from a awaze token) and the dish has 1 flame, so the hotness level is 3. It is handled with an injera card and 2 coffee tokens.

Finally, in panel **e**₁, the player intends to eat an extra-hot key sir dish. The player pays with a Rotate card and removes the dish with an injera card. The hotness level is 2, and is handled with 1 tahini token (already on the tile) and one coffee token. Notice that the player collects both the dish and the tahini token (panel **e**₂).

Eating an Empty Injera Tile

An empty tile may be eaten (removed from the board) only if it is in the player's reachable area and is removable, i.e., has at least 2 free vertices. Eating an empty tile is similar to a eating a dish, but has only 2 steps: **paying** and **handling hotness** (see steps 1 and 3 for eating a dish above).

Adding Tahini

When playing an Add Tahini card, place 3 tahini tokens on 3 adjacent tiles, forming a triangle, as in Fig. 5 (3 rightmost tiles). Tahini can **only** be put in such triangle, thus, tiles that can't be part of a triangle can't have tahini added to them. Tahini is added either to a dish tile or to an empty injera tile with no dish, and is consumed when the dish/empty injera is removed from the board. Adding tahini is **not** limited by reachable area restrictions. There is no limit to the number of tahini tokens on a tile.

For convenient score keeping, 3 tahini tokens consumed can be replaced with 1 big tahini token, rewarding the same as 3 standard ones.



Figure 5: Tahini and awaze tokens placement.

Adding Awaze

When playing an Add Awaze (hot sauce) card, add 3 awaze tokens to three tiles, as in Fig. 5. The same rules specified for adding tahini tokens are applied to awaze tokens. A tile can have both awaze and tahini tokens on top. When removing injera tiles with awaze, return the awaze to the box. When playing with special cards, collect the dish tile with the awaze on it; otherwise, return awaze tokens from dish tiles to the box.

Drink Cards

Drink tokens can be used to handle hotness, or be consumed as a separate action (Consume a Drink token), requiring nothing other than announcing the action and removing the token from the glass tile. Drink tokens are collected using Order Drinks cards. When playing an Order Drink card, place 3 tokens of the specified drink on top of your glass tile. Note that you can only have a single active drink at any time. You can only play an Order Drink card when your glass tile is empty of any tokens.

The first two drink tokens consumed are returned to the box. Consuming the last token, either as part of hotness handling or as a standalone Consume a Drink Token action, triggers a special effect, depending on the drink type.

- **Coffee:** when consuming the last coffee token, place the token in front of you for later scoring. Refill your hand to full hand size **plus** 1 card. That is, for 2–4 players, refill to a total of 5 cards, and for 5–6 players, refill to a total of 4 cards. End your turn **immediately**, without any additional actions.

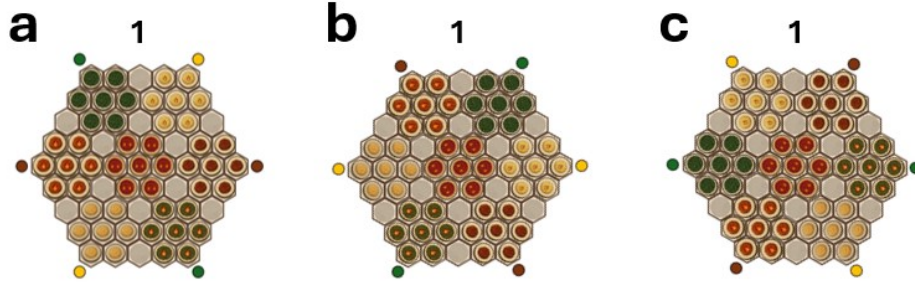


Figure 6: Rotate mechanism.

- **beer**: similar to coffee, when consuming the last beer token, place it in front of you and end your turn with no additional actions but refilling the hand. Refill to full hand size **minus** 1 card: 3 cards for 2–4 players, and 2 cards for 5–6 players.
- **water**: When consuming the last water token, return it to the box, and immediately draw cards to refill the hand to full size. Continue your turn. This effect only holds once per turn. If you used another Order Water card and consumed all 3 new water tokens, refill the hand to full size on consuming the last token and end your turn immediately.

Rotate Injera

Play a Rotate Injera card to change reachable areas and reach new dishes. When playing it, rotate the board 60° either clockwise or anticlockwise. All reachable areas are still defined by matching colors on either side of the board, but the colors change for all players.

For instance, in Fig. 6a, player 1's reachable area includes the row between the red circles and all tiles above. Rotating the board clockwise results in the positioning of Fig 6b, where player 1's reachable area includes the row between the yellow circles and all tiles above. Rotating the board anticlockwise results in the positioning of Fig. 6c. Player 1 can then reach all tiles between the green circles and above.

Discard & Redraw

At any point on your turn, you may discard your **entire** hand onto the discard pile and immediately draw the number of discarded cards minus 1, continuing your turn. You can do this any number of times during the turn.

End of Game

The game ends when one of the following occurs:

1. **All dish tiles are eaten.** The player who ate the last dish triggers a Final Round: after finishing his or hers turn, all other players take exactly one more turn, then the game ends. Do not refill hand at end of turns during Final Round.
2. **One full round passes without any dish being eaten.** The game ends immediately after a round is completed with no player eating a dish.

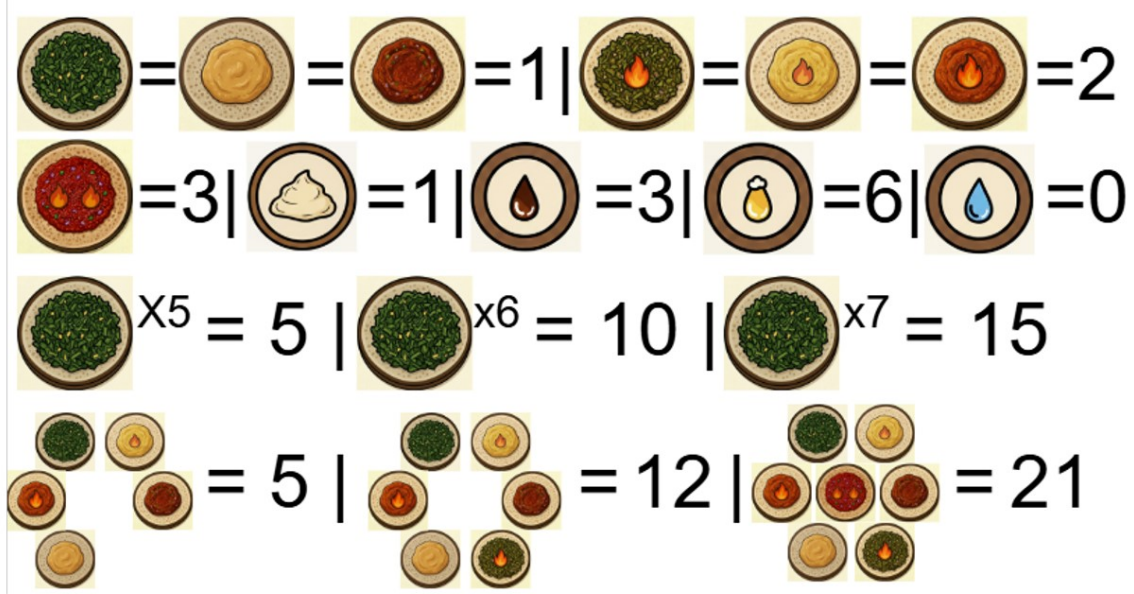


Figure 7: Scoring mechanism.

Scoring

At end game, calculate the scoring of each player. The player with the highest score wins. Scoring rules are summarized in Fig. 7. Each dish tile, tahini, coffee and beer tokens reward certain amount of points, as specified below. Notice that awaze does not change the scoring of dishes.

- Shiro (chickpeas stew, yellow): 1 point per tile.
- Gomen (greens dish, green): 1 point per tile.
- Azifa (Green lentils salad, reddish brown): 1 point per tile.
- Kik alicha (hot split-peas stew, yellow with a flame): 2 points per tile.
- Tikel gomen (hot potato and cabbage dish, light green with a flame): 2 points per tile.
- Misir wot (hot red lentils stew, red with a flame): 2 points per tile.
- Key sir (hot beetroot dish spiced with berbere, reddish purple with 2 flames): 3 points per tile.
- Tahini: 1 point per token.
- Coffee: 3 points per token.
- beer: 6 points per token.

A player gets a bonus of 5 points for every dish the player consumed exactly 5 tiles from. Consuming 6 tiles from the same dish rewards 10 points. Consuming all 7 tiles rewards 15 points. There are no bonuses for consuming 4 tiles or less from a dish.

Eating at least 1 tile from exactly 5 dish types rewards 5 points. Eating from exactly 6 dish types rewards 12 points. Eating from all 7 types rewards the highest bonus of 21 points.

Additional optional bonus points are rewarded based on special cards requirement.

Special Cards (Optional)

It is advisable to play without special cards until getting used to the game. Experienced players may add special cards to the gameplay for extra strategic depth.

At game setup, each player is dealt 3 special cards face-down and keeps 2 of them, discarding the redundant unseen. Special cards are revealed simultaneously at game end, and reward bonus points based on the logic described in the table below and on the cards themselves. Comparative bonuses (“*more/fewer than any other player*”) require a **strict** majority/minority; ties yield no bonus. In the table below, N denotes the number of players. Non-hot dishes with awaze are considered hot dishes when special cards are regarded.

Card	Bonus
4X4	+4 for each dish type of which you ate <i>exactly</i> 4 tiles; +4 if you tasted <i>exactly</i> 4 dish types.
Tahini party	+1 per 2 tahini tokens consumed (round down).
Sesame intolerance	+ $N + 4$ if you consumed either no tahini tokens or <i>fewer</i> tahini tokens than every other player.
Tahini queen	+ $2N$ if you consumed <i>more</i> tahini tokens than every other player.
Tasting menu	+5/ + 6/ + 7 if you tasted exactly 5/6/7 dish types (stacks with the “tasted all” bonus).
Picky eater	+15 if you tasted <i>exactly</i> 3 dish types.
Some like it hot	+1 per 2 hot dish tiles consumed (round down).
Too hot to handle	+ $2N$ if you consumed <i>more</i> hot dish tiles than every other player.
Beetroot boss	+2 per key sir tile consumed.
No hot for you!	+ $N + 4$ if you consumed either no hot dish tiles or <i>fewer</i> hot dish tiles than every other player.
Peas please	+1 per shiro or kik alicha tile eaten.
Peas prince	+ $N + 4$ if you consumed more peas dishes (shiro and kik alicha) than every other player.
Lentils freak	+1 per misir wot or azifa tile eaten.
Lentils princess	+ $N + 4$ if you consumed more lentil dishes (misir wot and azifa) than every other player.
Cabbage savage	+1 per gomen or tikel gomen tile eaten.
Cabbage king	+ $N + 4$ if you consumed more cabbage dishes (gomen and tikel gomen) than every other player.
Healthy appetite	+ $2N$ if you ate <i>more</i> dish tiles than every other player.
Consolation prize	+ $N + 4$ if you ate <i>fewer</i> dish tiles than every other player.
Delicate palate	+1 per 2 non-hot dish tiles consumed (round down).